

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP World History: Modern Free-Response Practice Exam 9

APWH-SAQ9-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 1 — The Global Tapestry

Period: c. 1200–1450

Theme: ECN — Economic Systems

Historical Reasoning: Mixed Historical Reasoning

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source 1: Historian Amina Garba, “Craft and Commerce in the Hausa Cities,” modern historical interpretation, 2021.

“Hausa city-states such as Kano and Katsina became important not simply because they lay near long-distance trade routes, but because they developed local industries, especially textile production, leatherworking, and market regulation. Urban rulers and merchant groups built power through regional exchange as much as through trans-Saharan commerce.”

Source 2: Historian Julian Reed, “Islam and Urban Authority in the Central Sudan,” modern historical interpretation, 2019.

“The growth of Hausa cities was closely tied to the spread of Islam among rulers, scholars, and merchants. Islamic learning, literacy, legal practices, and commercial trust helped connect local markets to wider networks across North and West Africa.”

- (a) Identify one difference between the two historians’ interpretations of Hausa city-states.
- (b) Describe one specific historical development that could be used to support one of the interpretations.
- (c) Explain one way urban or commercial development in the Hausa city-states was similar to or different from urban or commercial development in another region during c. 1200–1450.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a clear difference between the interpretations, such as Source 1 emphasizing local industries and regional markets while Source 2 emphasizes Islam, literacy, scholarship, and broader commercial trust.
- (b) 1 point: Describes a relevant development, such as textile production in Kano, leatherworking, regional market regulation, merchant groups, Islam among rulers and traders, Qur’anic schools, or links between Hausa cities and wider West African trade.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a valid similarity or difference with another region, such as the Swahili Coast, Mali, Song China, Southeast Asia, the Mediterranean, or South Asia, using specific evidence about cities, merchants, religion, production, markets, or state support.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should avoid reducing Hausa cities to only stops on trans-Saharan routes. Strong responses should show how local production, urban regulation, Islam, and merchant networks could all contribute to power. For part (c), the best answers compare a specific urban or commercial

feature, such as craft production, religious networks, market taxation, port trade, or written commercial practices.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ9-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 3 — Land-Based Empires

Period: c. 1450–1750

Theme: SIO — Social Interactions and Organization

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Petition from a village headman to domain officials in Tokugawa Japan, 1687. This excerpt is original but modeled on early modern Japanese village petitions.

“The households of this village have delivered the required rice, maintained the irrigation channels, and kept the registers of births and marriages. Yet last year’s storms damaged the fields, and several families have borrowed grain at high interest. If the assessment remains unchanged, some young men may flee to towns, leaving fewer hands for the next planting. We ask for a temporary reduction, not because we reject our duty, but because a village ruined by taxes cannot serve the lord well.”

(a) Identify the likely purpose of the petition.

(b) Explain how the petition reflects one feature of Tokugawa social or political order.

(c) Explain one limitation of the source as evidence for the experiences of all people in Tokugawa Japan.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Identifies a plausible purpose, such as requesting temporary tax reduction, explaining crop damage, persuading officials to preserve village stability, or preventing outmigration and debt.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant Tokugawa feature, such as village responsibility for tax collection, rice-based taxation, status hierarchy, regulation of peasant households, local administration through village headmen, or concern about peasants leaving agricultural production for towns.

(c) 1 point: Explains a valid limitation, such as the source representing a village headman rather than landless laborers, women, merchants, samurai, urban workers, outcast groups, or domain officials; or noting that petitions may emphasize hardship to gain tax relief.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should use the source’s purpose and audience. The village headman frames the request as loyal service to the lord, not rebellion. Strong answers should connect rice taxation, village administration, and social order without assuming the petition represents every group in Tokugawa society.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ9-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Cold War and Decolonization

Period: c. 1900–present

Theme: CDI — Cultural Developments and Interactions

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Description of a street mural painted in Tehran in 1979 after the Iranian Revolution.

The mural shows a crowd of men and women marching beneath banners with religious phrases and portraits of clerical leaders. A broken crown lies on the ground, and a large hand pushes away a figure labeled “foreign influence.” In the background are oil derricks, a university building, and a mosque. A slogan reads: “Independence, Faith, Justice.”

- (a) Identify one political or cultural goal suggested by the described mural.
- (b) Explain one cause of the Iranian Revolution.
- (c) Explain one way the mural reflects broader twentieth-century challenges to Western influence or secular authoritarian rule.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a valid goal, such as ending monarchy, opposing foreign influence, promoting religious government, claiming social justice, asserting national independence, or mobilizing popular support.
- (b) 1 point: Explains a valid cause of the Iranian Revolution, such as opposition to the shah’s authoritarianism, resentment of Western influence, inequality tied to oil wealth, religious opposition to secularization, political repression, or anger over modernization policies that disrupted traditional groups.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a broader pattern, such as anti-Western nationalism, religious revival in politics, opposition to secular authoritarian states, criticism of foreign-backed regimes, control of oil resources, or popular mobilization against Cold War-aligned governments.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should interpret the mural as revolutionary propaganda. The broken crown, religious banners, oil derricks, mosque, university, and anti-foreign imagery all point to a movement that combined political, cultural, economic, and religious grievances. Strong answers should avoid describing the revolution as only religious or only anti-Western.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-DBQ9-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 9 — Globalization

Period: c. 1900–present

Theme: ECN — Economic Systems

Historical Reasoning: Continuity and Change Over Time

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which global consumer culture changed economic and cultural life from c. 1950 to 2000.

Document 1

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Advertisement script for a household refrigerator, 1958, São Paulo, Brazil.

Source Type: Advertisement script.

“The modern family deserves freshness, cleanliness, and time saved for a better life. With monthly payments, your home can join the new age of comfort. Keep food longer, welcome guests proudly, and show that your household is ready for tomorrow.”

Sourcing cues: Commercial advertisement aimed at urban middle-class consumers; links consumer goods to modernity, status, and domestic life.

Document 2

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Report from a Japanese electronics export association, 1967, Tokyo.

Source Type: Trade report.

“Portable radios and televisions have become symbols of national recovery and technical skill. Overseas buyers increasingly associate Japanese products with reliability and lower cost. Export growth depends on factory discipline, design improvement, and the ability to adapt goods to local tastes in North America, Southeast Asia, and Europe.”

Sourcing cues: Export industry perspective; emphasizes production, national recovery, and global markets.

Document 3

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Description of a street photograph taken in Lagos, Nigeria, 1976.

Source Type: Described photograph.

The photograph shows a busy street with a cinema billboard for an Indian film, a shop selling imported radios, a Coca-Cola sign painted beside a local food stall, and young people wearing both locally tailored clothing and Western-style shirts. A newspaper kiosk displays headlines about oil revenue and inflation.

Sourcing cues: Urban visual source; shows mixing of imported media, global brands, local food, clothing choices, and oil-era economic change.

Document 4

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Consumer goods availability table compiled by a government planning office, Poland, 1982.

Source Type: Plain-text data table.

Selected Consumer Goods in Urban Shops, Poland, 1982

Good Reported Availability

Meat Irregular; long lines common

Washing machines Limited; waiting lists common

Imported jeans Rare; often obtained through informal exchange

Televisions Available but expensive

Coffee Shortages frequent

Domestic shoes Available but quality complaints common

Note on the table: The report stated that shortages contributed to informal markets and public dissatisfaction.

Sourcing cues: State planning office perspective; reveals limits of consumer abundance in a socialist economy.

Document 5

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Speech by a cultural minister in France, 1989, Paris.

Source Type: Government speech.

“We do not reject foreign music, films, or restaurants. But when every screen, sign, and product teaches the same commercial language, smaller cultures risk becoming decoration. A nation must support its own cinema, publishing, and education if it wishes to participate in the world without disappearing into it.”

Sourcing cues: Government cultural official; concerned about cultural protection and U.S.-led commercial globalization.

Document 6

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Statement from a women’s cooperative selling embroidered clothing to tourists, 1994, Guatemala.

Source Type: Cooperative statement.

“Tourists ask for traditional patterns, but they also want new colors, sizes, and prices. Selling to visitors and foreign shops brings cash for school fees and medicines. Yet some designs are copied by factories, and younger women sometimes learn what sells before they learn what the patterns mean.”

Sourcing cues: Local producer perspective; shows opportunity and cultural tension in global tourist and export markets.

Document 7

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Interview with a youth radio host, 1998, Johannesburg, South Africa.

Source Type: Interview excerpt.

“Our listeners want hip-hop, kwaito, American R&B, and songs in local languages. They do not see this as choosing between global and African. They mix sounds, clothes, slang, and politics. The problem is not that culture travels; the problem is who owns the stations, who gets paid, and whose voice becomes fashionable.”

Sourcing cues: Youth media perspective after apartheid; emphasizes cultural mixing, ownership, and unequal access to media markets.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which global consumer culture changed economic and cultural life from c. 1950 to 2000. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning, such as arguing that consumer culture

expanded global markets, mass media, and aspirations for modern lifestyles while also producing shortages, cultural resistance, hybrid identities, and unequal control over profits and media.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader historical context relevant to global consumer culture, such as postwar economic growth, decolonization, the Cold War, mass production, television, advertising, Japanese export growth, oil economies, socialist planning, neoliberal globalization, tourism, or the spread of multinational corporations.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point by accurately using the content of at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points by using at least six documents to support an argument about consumer goods, advertising, exports, media, shortages, cultural protection, tourism, hybrid culture, or unequal ownership.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by using at least one specific piece of relevant outside evidence not found in the documents, such as McDonaldisation, Hollywood film distribution, satellite television, the rise of multinational corporations, container shipping, East Asian export economies, oil shocks, informal markets in communist states, blue jeans as a consumer symbol, or global tourism.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. Effective examples include explaining why advertisements linked appliances to modern family life, why Japanese exporters emphasized reliability and adaptation, why socialist planning reports reveal dissatisfaction, why cultural ministers worried about commercial homogenization, or why cooperatives and youth media producers emphasized both opportunity and unequal ownership.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a more complex understanding of consumer culture. This may include explaining that globalization did not simply homogenize culture, that local consumers adapted global goods and media, that socialist and capitalist systems experienced consumer pressures differently, or that consumer culture created both opportunity and dependency.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ could argue that global consumer culture significantly changed economic and cultural life by expanding demand for household goods, electronics, branded products, media, tourism, and youth culture, but that the changes were uneven and often contested. Documents 1 and 2 support arguments about modern consumer aspirations and export production. Documents 3, 6, and 7 show cultural mixing and local adaptation. Document 4 shows that consumer expectations also created dissatisfaction in shortage economies. Document 5 shows cultural resistance to commercial homogenization. Outside evidence could include Hollywood, McDonald's, satellite television, multinational corporations, blue jeans, container shipping, East Asian export economies, or global tourism. Strong sourcing should compare advertisers, export associations, government planners, cultural officials, local producers, and youth media workers.

Expected Points:

7

APWH-LEQ9-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 3 — Land-Based Empires

Period: c. 1750–1900

Theme: GOV — Governance

Historical Reasoning: Comparison

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

During the nineteenth century, several land-based empires faced military defeats, internal rebellions, fiscal pressure, and growing foreign influence. Some imperial governments attempted

reforms in administration, military organization, education, law, infrastructure, or industry to preserve sovereignty and strengthen the state.

Compare reform efforts in the Ottoman Empire and Qing China during the nineteenth century.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that compares reform efforts in the Ottoman Empire and Qing China during the nineteenth century. A strong thesis should identify a meaningful similarity and/or difference and establish a line of reasoning.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader context relevant to nineteenth-century imperial reform, such as European industrial and military power, imperialism, unequal treaties, internal rebellions, fiscal crisis, nationalist movements, missionary activity, military defeats, or the global spread of industrial technologies.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point by identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as the Tanzimat reforms, Ottoman constitutionalism, new schools, legal reforms, Janissary abolition, Self-Strengthening Movement, Tongzhi Restoration, arsenals, shipyards, treaty ports, Taiping Rebellion, Opium Wars, or foreign advisers. Earns 2 points by using at least two pieces of evidence to support a comparison of Ottoman and Qing reforms.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by using comparison to explain similarities and/or differences in reform efforts. Strong responses might compare military modernization, administrative centralization, legal reform, adoption of foreign technology, resistance by conservative elites, or different degrees of constitutional and educational reform.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced understanding of imperial reform. This may include explaining that reforms aimed to preserve empire rather than simply imitate Europe, that reform was constrained by internal opposition and foreign pressure, that technology could be adopted without full political transformation, or that reform outcomes differed because of different social structures, regional pressures, and imperial institutions.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should directly compare the Ottoman Empire and Qing China rather than writing two separate narratives. Useful evidence might include the Tanzimat, Ottoman legal and educational reforms, constitutional experiments, military reform, the Self-Strengthening Movement, arsenals and shipyards, the Opium Wars, the Taiping Rebellion, treaty ports, and foreign advisers. Strong responses should explain how both empires attempted to strengthen themselves under pressure, while also showing differences in reform scope, political institutions, resistance, and results.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APWH-FRQ9

· APWH-SAQ9-001: Unit 1 — The Global Tapestry; c. 1200–1450; Hausa city-states / Kano, Katsina, central Sudan, West Africa, and wider North/West African connections; secondary text source with two modern historians; source perspectives contrast local craft production, textile industries, leatherworking, market regulation, and regional exchange with Islam, literacy, scholarship, legal practices, and commercial trust; historical development is Hausa urban-commercial development and Islamic-linked merchant networks; reasoning path compares economic and cultural explanations for urban power; misconception targeted: Hausa cities were only passive stops on trans-Saharan routes rather than active centers of production, regulation, and Islamic urban culture.

· APWH-SAQ9-002: Unit 3 — Land-Based Empires; c. 1450–1750; Tokugawa Japan / village

administration, rice taxation, irrigation, household registers, rural debt, and migration to towns; primary text source is an original village headman petition to domain officials; source perspective is a local intermediary seeking tax relief while affirming loyalty to the lord; historical development is Tokugawa social order, village responsibility, rice-based taxation, household control, and status hierarchy; reasoning path focuses on purpose, social-political order, and source limitation for non-headman groups; misconception targeted: Tokugawa order was maintained only by samurai coercion rather than village administration, taxation, and negotiated petitions.

· APWH-SAQ9-003: Unit 8 — Cold War and Decolonization; c. 1900–present; Iran / Tehran, Iranian Revolution, oil politics, monarchy, mosque, university, clerical leadership, and anti-foreign influence; non-text source type is a described revolutionary street mural; visual/data/map pattern includes marching crowd, religious banners, clerical portraits, broken crown, anti-foreign image, oil derricks, university, mosque, and “Independence, Faith, Justice” slogan; historical development is Iranian Revolution as political, religious, cultural, economic, and anti-authoritarian mobilization; reasoning path is causation and broader challenge to Western influence and secular authoritarian rule; misconception targeted: the Iranian Revolution was only religious or only anti-Western without social, economic, and political causes.

· APWH-DBQ9-001: Unit 9 — Globalization; c. 1900–present; Brazil, Japan, Nigeria, Poland, France, Guatemala, South Africa, and global consumer/media markets; DBQ topic is global consumer culture changing economic and cultural life from c. 1950 to 2000; document types include appliance advertisement script, electronics export report, described Lagos street photograph, socialist consumer goods availability table, cultural minister speech, women’s cooperative statement, and youth radio host interview; document perspectives include advertisers, export industry associations, urban visual observers, socialist planning offices, cultural protection officials, local producers in tourist markets, and youth media workers; main argument paths include modern household aspirations, export-led production, branded goods, media circulation, socialist shortages, cultural protection, tourism, hybrid culture, unequal ownership, and consumer dissatisfaction; outside evidence possibilities include McDonaldisation, Hollywood, satellite television, multinational corporations, container shipping, East Asian export economies, oil shocks, blue jeans, informal markets, and global tourism; sourcing opportunities include advertising persuasion, export association boosterism, urban photograph evidence of hybridity, state planning limits, cultural-ministry defense of national culture, cooperative producer tensions, and youth media ownership critique.

· APWH-LEQ9-001: Unit 3 — Land-Based Empires; c. 1750–1900; Ottoman Empire and Qing China in the nineteenth century; LEQ topic is comparison of imperial reform efforts under military, fiscal, internal, and foreign pressure; historical reasoning process is comparison; evidence categories include Tanzimat reforms, Ottoman constitutionalism, new schools, legal reforms, Janissary abolition, Self-Strengthening Movement, Tongzhi Restoration, arsenals, shipyards, treaty ports, Taiping Rebellion, Opium Wars, foreign advisers, and unequal treaties; complexity path compares reforms as strategies to preserve empire, weighing military modernization, administrative centralization, legal change, technological adoption, elite resistance, internal rebellion, foreign pressure, and uneven outcomes; misconception targeted: Ottoman and Qing reforms were simple Western imitation or complete failures without meaningful institutional change.